fine-tuned to obtain the latest and relevant information based on latest data on as many as 127 attributes to give stakeholders more realistic, updated and accurate information. More than 2,000 B-schools, fulfilling the qualification criteria for participation, were contacted and followed up to participate in the objective survey. In all, 279 B-schools submitted their objective data within the timeline, and 277 were ranked; the remaining were not eligible for the ranking due to not meeting the qualifying criteria.

After receiving the objective data, data cleaning, logical checks and validation, back-checks and audits were conducted. In the first stage, every aspect of the details provided by B-schools was carefully examined through available information and MDRA's database. In the second stage, verification and physical audits of participating B-schools were conducted by MDRA researchers to ensure the accuracy and correctness of the data submitted by the institutes.

The five key parameters of evaluation were: a) Learning Experience, b) Living Experience, c) Placement Performance, d) Selection Process, Governance and Establishment and e) Future Orientation.

The scores of these parameters were then summed up to get the total objective score for each institute.

The final ranks to B-schools were based on Objective data after various levels of cross-validation through multiple sources and physical audits.

Looking into the country's large landscape and regional preferences for some students, based on the overall rank—separate zonal rankings, parameter-wise rankings, and RoI-based rankings were derived from the main rankings.

Further, to give newer good B-schools a fair chance, a separate list of Top Emerging MBA courses was created (colleges from which the first batch passed out after 2015 were considered for this list).

New addition: Most Improved B-schools

In a significant addition to this year's ranking, "Most Improved B-schools" has been introduced. This ranking captures the five-year growth trajectory of B-schools by analysing the change in their relative positions in the annual *BT*-MDRA Best B-schools Rankings from 2022 to 2026. It focuses on the percentage improvement in rank, thereby offering a dynamic perspective on institutional performance, rather than a static snapshot.

For Other Rankings

- **Executive Programmes:** Executive programmes offered by Indian B-schools vary widely in terms of target audience, specialisation, curriculum, pedagogy, delivery mode, faculty quality, alumni benefits and fees. These programmes generally do not award an MBA or equivalent degree/diploma. To ensure wider relevance, the rankings considered only rigorous, long-running general management programmes offered by leading institutes. The Top 15 programmes were ranked using objective data from secondary research, covering parameters such as fees, institute reputation, course sustainability, weekly interactions, eligibility, online/offline classes and pedagogy.

- **Advanced Management Programmes (AMPs):** The ranking of AMPs was based on objective data. Only programmes targeting senior working professionals with a minimum of 10 years' work

Top Executive Programmes, Top Advanced Management Programmes, Top Executive Fellow Programmes in Management, Top Fellow Programmes in Management/PhDs, Top online MBAs, along with a listing of Top global B-Schools, were included in the ranking

	PARAMETERS	WEIGHTAGE
1	Learning Experience	250
2	Living Experience	150
3	Placement Performance	250
4	Selection Process, Governance, and Establishment	150
5	Future Orientation	200
	TOTAL	**1,000**